Kelso and Case-Tec

By Jose Cruz Gonzales

INTRODUCTION

According to the website Childhelp.org, in 2009, approximately 3.3 million child abuse reports and allegations were made involving an estimated 6 million children. About 80% of 21 year olds who were abused as children met criteria for at least one psychological disorder. The confusion that comes in these broken homes creates unique sibling relationships as seen in Kelso and Case-Tec by Jose Cruz Gonzales.

(*Kelso and CASE-TEC watch a television set. KELSO surfs the channels by remote.*)

KELSO: See there he is again.

CASE-TEC: No way.

KELSO: It looks just like him but younger.

CASE-TEC: Go back.

KELSO (*changes the remote*): See!

CASE-TEC: That's impossible.

KELSO: Dude, I'm telling you it's him.

CASE-TEC: Give it here! (*CASE-TEC takes the remote from KELSO.*)

KELSO: Okay, there he is as an old man with a white beard carrying two stone tablets.

CASE-TEC: He's Mosese, right?

KELSO: Here, the apes put him in prison.

CASE-TEC: It's *Planet of the Apes*.

KELSO: I like Marky Mark's version better.

CASE-TEC: Wow, check her out.

KELSO: Who?

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CASE-TEC: The babe wearing the bikini in jail with him stupid.

KELSO: Oh, yeah.

CASE-TEC: And now, he's really old holding a musket over his head smiling like an idiot.

KELSO: Weird.

CASE-TEC: What's his name?

KELSO: I don't know.

CASE-TEC: Who cares? (*The phone rings. They both jump to get it. CASE-TEC grabs it.*) Hello? Yeah, it's me. He's here too. Ah-huh?

KELSO: Let me listen

CASE-TEC: Shhh! Yeah. Okay. Ah-huh. Ah-huh. Okay. (*CASE-TEC hangs up the phone.*)

KELSO: Well?

CASE-TEC: Nothing's changed.

KELSO: How long do we gotta wait?

CASE-TEC: 'Til something changes.

KELSO: Is Mom going to-

CASE-TEC: I don't know.

KELSO: Did we do the right thing?

CASE-TEC: We had to do it.

KELSO: But what if Pop hadn't-

CASE-TEC: It wouldn't have mattered. He always blows up.

KELSO: What's going to happen to us?

CASE-TEC: Why are you asking so many questions?

KELSO: just want things the way they were.

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CASE-TEC: We're never going back to that house. (*KELSO picks up a game controller.*)

KELSO: I'm playing a video game.

CASE-TEC: Dude, the thing's broken.

KELSO: I know that.

CASE-TEC: Nothing works around here.

KELSO: There's nothing else to do.

CASE-TEC: So you're going to pretend you're playing a game?

KELSO: Go away. (*KELSO pretends to play a video game.*)

CASE-TEC: So what's the game? "Medal of Honor Frontline"?

KELSO: No.

CASE-TEC: "NBA Live"?

KELSO: Yeah, right.

CASE-TEC: "Lord of the Rings"? (*Beat.*) I knew it! It's a dumb game.

KELSO: I always beat you.

CASE-TEC: No you don't.

KELSO: You cry every time.

CASE-TEC: Wanna Bet?

KELSO: You're on! (*CASE-TEC sits beside KELSO. They pretend to play. They are very animated pretending to play. CASE-TEC tosses the game controller down.*)

CASE-TEC: I win!

KELSO: No, you cheated.

CASE-TEC: Prove it.

KELSO: I can't.

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CASE-TEC: Loser.

KELSO: Cheat. (*KELSO picks up the remote, changing channels again. Beat.*) I'm scared, Case-Tec.

CASE-TEC: I know, Kelso, I am too.

KELSO: Why did Mom do it?

CASE-TEC: She said something made her feel everything was going to be okay.

KELSO: Like what?

CASE-TEC: Like a giant hand protecting us.

KELSO: DO you think she's going to make it out of the hospital?

CASE-TEC: I don't think she can feel a thing right now.

KELSO: He shouldn't have hit her.

CASE-TEC: He was crying like a baby when they took him away.

KELSO: He's going to be mad later.

CASE-TEC: he's never going to lay a hand on us again.

KELSO: Mom led us out of there, didn't she?

CASE-TEC: Yeah, just like that guy in the movie with the stone tablets. (*The phone rings. They both rush to it. CASE-TEC answers it.*) Hello? Yeah? (*CASE-TEC shares the phone so KELSO can hear.*)

KELSO: I'm here.

CASE-TEC: How is she?

KELSO: Is Mom going to be okay?

CASE-TEC: Yes!

KELSO: When can we see her?

CASE-TEC: Soon?

KELSO: I want to go there now.

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CASE-TEC: We can't. Yes? Okay. Thanks.

KELSO: 'Bye.

CASE-TEC (*hangs up the phone. He starts to cry*): You better not tell anybody.

KELSO: I won't.

CASE-TEC: 'Cause if you do-

KELSO: Is Mom going to remember what happened?

CASE-TEC: I hope so.

KELSO: What if she doesn't?

CASE-TEC: Then we gotta tell the truth.

KELSO: Pop's not going to like it.

CASE-TEC: Who cares? It's you, Mom and me. That's all that matters, right?

KELSO: Right.

CASE-TEC: So you wanna play?

KELSO: Nah. You want the remote?

CASE-TEC: Sure. (*CASE-TEC starts surfing the channels.*)

KELSO: Wait!

CASE-TEC: What is it?

KELSO: There he is again.

CASE-TEC: No way!

KELSO: This time he's driving a chariot!

CASE-TEC: That dude's on every channel!

KELSO (*turns off the television*): Not anymore! (*Beat.*) Case-Tec, are we going to be okay?

CASE-TEC: Yeah, we're going to be okay, Kelso.

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SOURCE INFORMATION

Author: Jose Cruz Gonzales
Book: 10 by 10
ISBN: 978- 1583422410
Publisher: Dramatic Publishing
Date (Month/Year): 2004

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